

Safe searching online

Name:

Class:

1: Search engines

You are going to find out the answers to the questions below. You will do this by working in pairs. One pupil searches and the other observes how they search and makes a note of the exact keywords that were typed in.

Question	Answer	Keywords Used
1. What is the tallest mountain in South America and how high is it?		
2. Which country has the most official languages and how many does it have?		
3. In what year was the first email sent and who sent it?		
4. Which animal is known as the "ship of the desert" and why is it called that?		
5. What is the smallest country in the world by land area and where is it located?		

2: Search engines

Work in pairs to think of a question or topic to search for. For example: "What are the benefits of renewable energy?" or "Who invented the internet?" Make sure it's something you're curious about and that will give detailed results.

Use Google for your first search and use Bing for your second search.

Type the exact same query into both search engines and look at the first 5 results from each search engine and then answer the questions below.

Question	Answer
1. Are the results the same or different?	
2. Do the top results come from well-known websites or lesser-known ones?	
3. Are there any advertisements at the top of the page?	
4. How easy is it to find the answer to your question?	

3: Search Engines

Write 2–3 sentences explaining why search engines might not always show the best or fairest results.
